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Timer-XL Revisited: A Hands-On Guide to Zero-Shot Forecasting

Two practical use cases of this pretrained model in action

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[Part 1](#) discussed Timer-XL in-depth, and what makes this model unique.

In short, Timer-XL is a milestone because it provides:

1. **Unified forecasting:** One model handles varying context and prediction lengths.
2. **Time Attention:** A novel attention mechanism that avoids the flaw in standard attention for time series (which assumes permutation invariance of observations) and distinguishes the different covariates—while preserving permutation-equivalence.

Fortunately, the univariate pretrained version of Timer-XL is open-source!

This article walks through 2 tutorials on using Timer-XL for:

- **Long-context forecasting** on the ETTh2 dataset — with rolling forecast for a more rigorous evaluation.
- **Fun case:** Forecasting financial time series (S&P 500).

Let's get started!

✓ Find the **2 Timer-XL** notebooks in the [AI Projects folder](#) (Project 18 and Project 19)

ETTh2 Forecasting

Timer-XL is a pretrained model, so there are only a few public datasets available that avoid data leakage...

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